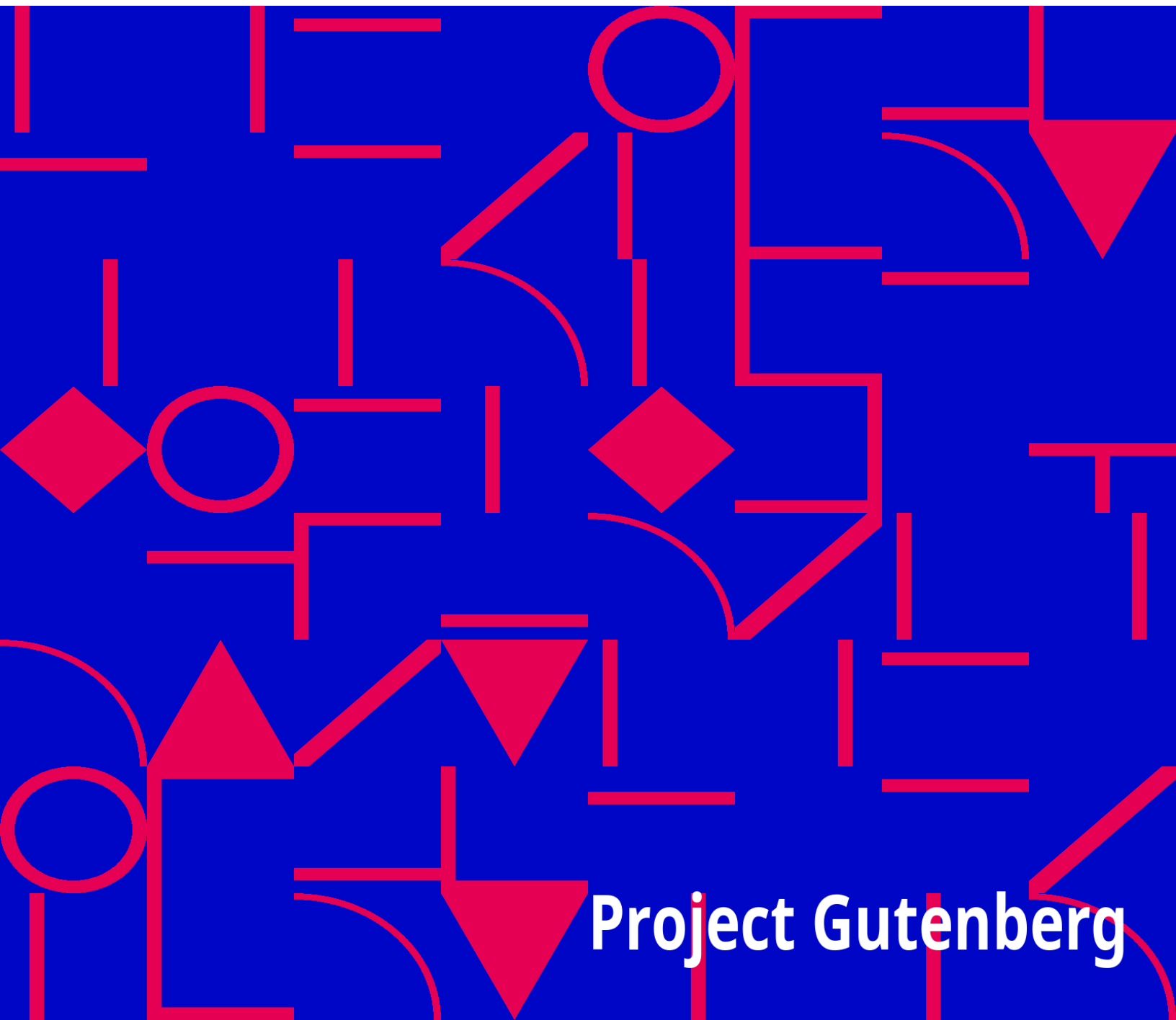


The World English Bible (WEB): 2 Corinthians

Anonymous

The background of the lower half of the page is a solid blue color. Overlaid on this is a complex, abstract pattern of red geometric shapes and lines. The pattern includes various elements such as straight lines of different lengths, circles, diamonds, triangles, and quarter-circles, some of which are interconnected to form larger, more complex structures. The overall effect is a vibrant, modern, and geometric design.

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The World English Bible (WEB): 2 Corinthians

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE WORLD
ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB): 2 CORINTHIANS ***

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Book 47 2 Corinthians 001:001
Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus
through the will of God, and
Timothy our brother, to the
assembly of God which is at
Corinth, with all the saints who are
in the whole of Achaia: 001:002
Grace to you and peace from God
our Father and the Lord Jesus
Christ. 001:003 Blessed be the God
and Father of our Lord Jesus
Christ, the Father of mercies and

God of all comfort; 001:004 who comforts us in all our affliction, that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction, through the comfort with which we ourselves are comforted by God.

001:005 For as the sufferings of Christ abound to us, even so our comfort also abounds through Christ. 001:006 But if we are afflicted, it is for your comfort and salvation. If we are comforted, it is for your comfort, which produces in you the patient enduring of the same sufferings which we also suffer. 001:007 Our hope for you is steadfast, knowing that, since you are partakers of the sufferings, so

**also are you of the comfort. 001:008
For we don't desire to have you
uninformed, brothers,{The word
for "brothers" here and where
context allows may also be
correctly translated "brothers and
sisters" or "siblings."} concerning
our affliction which happened to us
in Asia, that we were weighed down
exceedingly, beyond our power, so
much that we despaired even of
life. 001:009 Yes, we ourselves have
had the sentence of death within
ourselves, that we should not trust
in ourselves, but in God who raises
the dead, 001:010 who delivered us
out of so great a death, and does
deliver; on whom we have set our**

hope that he will also still deliver us; 001:011 you also helping together on our behalf by your supplication; that, for the gift bestowed on us by means of many, thanks may be given by many persons on your behalf. 001:012 For our boasting is this: the testimony of our conscience, that in holiness and sincerity of God, not in fleshly wisdom but in the grace of God we behaved ourselves in the world, and more abundantly toward you. 001:013 For we write no other things to you, than what you read or even acknowledge, and I hope you will acknowledge to the end; 001:014 as also you

acknowledged us in part, that we are your boasting, even as you also are ours, in the day of our Lord Jesus. 001:015 In this confidence, I was determined to come first to you, that you might have a second benefit; 001:016 and by you to pass into Macedonia, and again from Macedonia to come to you, and to be sent forward by you on my journey to Judea. 001:017 When I therefore was thus determined, did I show fickleness? Or the things that I purpose, do I purpose according to the flesh, that with me there should be the "Yes, yes" and the "No, no?" 001:018 But as God is faithful, our word toward you

was not "Yes and no." 001:019 For the Son of God, Jesus Christ, who was preached among you by us, by me, Silvanus, and Timothy, was not "Yes and no," but in him is "Yes." 001:020 For however many are the promises of God, in him is the "Yes." Therefore also through him is the "Amen," to the glory of God through us. 001:021 Now he who establishes us with you in Christ, and anointed us, is God; 001:022 who also sealed us, and gave us the down payment of the Spirit in our hearts. 001:023 But I call God for a witness to my soul, that I didn't come to Corinth to spare you. 001:024 Not that we have lordship

over your faith, but are fellow workers with you for your joy. For you stand firm in faith. 002:001 But I determined this for myself, that I would not come to you again in sorrow. 002:002 For if I make you sorry, then who will make me glad but he who is made sorry by me? 002:003 And I wrote this very thing to you, so that, when I came, I wouldn't have sorrow from them of whom I ought to rejoice; having confidence in you all, that my joy would be shared by all of you. 002:004 For out of much affliction and anguish of heart I wrote to you with many tears, not that you should be made sorry, but that you

might know the love that I have so abundantly for you. 002:005 But if any has caused sorrow, he has caused sorrow, not to me, but in part (that I not press too heavily) to you all. 002:006 Sufficient to such a one is this punishment which was inflicted by the many; 002:007 so that on the contrary you should rather forgive him and comfort him, lest by any means such a one should be swallowed up with his excessive sorrow. 002:008

Therefore I beg you to confirm your love toward him. 002:009 For to this end I also wrote, that I might know the proof of you, whether you are obedient in all

**things. 002:010 Now I also forgive
whomever you forgive anything.
For if indeed I have forgiven
anything, I have forgiven that one
for your sakes in the presence of
Christ, 002:011 that no advantage
may be gained over us by Satan;
for we are not ignorant of his
schemes. 002:012 Now when I came
to Troas for the Good News of
Christ, and when a door was
opened to me in the Lord, 002:013 I
had no relief for my spirit, because
I didn't find Titus, my brother, but
taking my leave of them, I went out
into Macedonia. 002:014 Now
thanks be to God, who always leads
us in triumph in Christ, and reveals**

through us the sweet aroma of his knowledge in every place. 002:015 For we are a sweet aroma of Christ to God, in those who are saved, and in those who perish; 002:016 to the one a stench from death to death; to the other a sweet aroma from life to life. Who is sufficient for these things? 002:017 For we are not as so many, peddling the word of God. But as of sincerity, but as of God, in the sight of God, we speak in Christ. 003:001 Are we beginning again to commend ourselves? Or do we need, as do some, letters of commendation to you or from you? 003:002 You are our letter, written in our hearts, known and read by

**all men; 003:003 being revealed
that you are a letter of Christ,
served by us, written not with ink,
but with the Spirit of the living
God; not in tablets of stone, but in
tablets that are hearts of flesh.**

**003:004 Such confidence we have
through Christ toward God;**

**003:005 not that we are sufficient of
ourselves, to account anything as
from ourselves; but our sufficiency
is from God; 003:006 who also
made us sufficient as servants of a
new covenant; not of the letter, but
of the Spirit. For the letter kills, but
the Spirit gives life. 003:007 But if
the service of death, written
engraved on stones, came with**

glory, so that the children of Israel could not look steadfastly on the face of Moses for the glory of his face; which was passing away:

003:008 won't service of the Spirit be with much more glory? 003:009

For if the service of condemnation has glory, the service of righteousness exceeds much more in glory. 003:010 For most certainly that which has been made glorious has not been made glorious in this respect, by reason of the glory that surpasses. 003:011 For if that which passes away was with glory, much more that which remains is in glory. 003:012 Having therefore such a hope, we use great boldness

**of speech, 003:013 and not as
Moses, who put a veil on his face,
that the children of Israel wouldn't
look steadfastly on the end of that
which was passing away. 003:014
But their minds were hardened, for
until this very day at the reading of
the old covenant the same veil
remains, because in Christ it passes
away. 003:015 But to this day, when
Moses is read, a veil lies on their
heart. 003:016 But whenever one
turns to the Lord, the veil is taken
away. 003:017 Now the Lord is the
Spirit and where the Spirit of the
Lord is, there is liberty. 003:018
But we all, with unveiled face
beholding as in a mirror the glory**

of the Lord, are transformed into the same image from glory to glory, even as from the Lord, the Spirit.

004:001 Therefore seeing we have this ministry, even as we obtained mercy, we don't faint. 004:002 But we have renounced the hidden things of shame, not walking in craftiness, nor handling the word of God deceitfully; but by the manifestation of the truth commending ourselves to every man's conscience in the sight of God. 004:003 Even if our Good News is veiled, it is veiled in those who perish; 004:004 in whom the god of this world has blinded the minds of the unbelieving, that the

**light of the Good News of the glory
of Christ, who is the image of God,
should not dawn on them. 004:005
For we don't preach ourselves, but
Christ Jesus as Lord, and ourselves
as your servants for Jesus' sake;
004:006 seeing it is God who said,
"Light will shine out of darkness,"
{Genesis 1:3} who has shone in our
hearts, to give the light of the
knowledge of the glory of God in
the face of Jesus Christ. 004:007
But we have this treasure in clay
vessels, that the exceeding
greatness of the power may be of
God, and not from ourselves.
004:008 We are pressed on every
side, yet not crushed; perplexed,**

**yet not to despair; 004:009
pursued, yet not forsaken; struck
down, yet not destroyed; 004:010
always carrying in the body the
putting to death of the Lord Jesus,
that the life of Jesus may also be
revealed in our body. 004:011 For
we who live are always delivered to
death for Jesus' sake, that the life
also of Jesus may be revealed in
our mortal flesh. 004:012 So then
death works in us, but life in you.
004:013 But having the same spirit
of faith, according to that which is
written, "I believed, and therefore I
spoke." {Psalm 116:10} We also
believe, and therefore also we
speak; 004:014 knowing that he**

who raised the Lord Jesus will raise us also with Jesus, and will present us with you. 004:015 For all things are for your sakes, that the grace, being multiplied through the many, may cause the thanksgiving to abound to the glory of God.

004:016 Therefore we don't faint, but though our outward man is decaying, yet our inward man is renewed day by day. 004:017 For our light affliction, which is for the moment, works for us more and more exceedingly an eternal weight of glory; 004:018 while we don't look at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen. For the things which are seen

**are temporal, but the things which
are not seen are eternal. 005:001**

**For we know that if the earthly
house of our tent is dissolved, we
have a building from God, a house
not made with hands, eternal, in
the heavens. 005:002 For most
certainly in this we groan, longing
to be clothed with our habitation
which is from heaven; 005:003 if so
be that being clothed we will not be
found naked. 005:004 For indeed
we who are in this tent do groan,
being burdened; not that we desire
to be unclothed, but that we desire
to be clothed, that what is mortal
may be swallowed up by life.**

005:005 Now he who made us for

this very thing is God, who also gave to us the down payment of the Spirit. 005:006 Therefore, we are always confident and know that while we are at home in the body, we are absent from the Lord; 005:007 for we walk by faith, not by sight. 005:008 We are of good courage, I say, and are willing rather to be absent from the body, and to be at home with the Lord. 005:009 Therefore also we make it our aim, whether at home or absent, to be well pleasing to him. 005:010 For we must all be revealed before the judgment seat of Christ; that each one may receive the things in the body,

**according to what he has done,
whether good or bad. 005:011
Knowing therefore the fear of the
Lord, we persuade men, but we are
revealed to God; and I hope that
we are revealed also in your
consciences. 005:012 For we are not
commending ourselves to you
again, but speak as giving you
occasion of boasting on our behalf,
that you may have something to
answer those who boast in
appearance, and not in heart.
005:013 For if we are beside
ourselves, it is for God. Or if we are
of sober mind, it is for you. 005:014
For the love of Christ constrains
us; because we judge thus, that one**

died for all, therefore all died.

005:015 He died for all, that those who live should no longer live to themselves, but to him who for their sakes died and rose again.

005:016 Therefore we know no one after the flesh from now on. Even though we have known Christ after the flesh, yet now we know him so no more. 005:017 Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old things have passed away. Behold, all things have become new. 005:018 But all things are of God, who reconciled us to himself through Jesus Christ, and gave to us the ministry of reconciliation; 005:019 namely, that

God was in Christ reconciling the world to himself, not reckoning to them their trespasses, and having committed to us the word of reconciliation. 005:020 We are therefore ambassadors on behalf of Christ, as though God were entreating by us. We beg you on behalf of Christ, be reconciled to God. 005:021 For him who knew no sin he made to be sin on our behalf; so that in him we might become the righteousness of God. 006:001 Working together, we entreat also that you not receive the grace of God in vain, 006:002 for he says, "At an acceptable time I listened to you, in a day of salvation I helped

you." {Isaiah 49:8} Behold, now is the acceptable time. Behold, now is the day of salvation. 006:003 We give no occasion of stumbling in anything, that our service may not be blamed, 006:004 but in everything commending ourselves, as servants of God, in great endurance, in afflictions, in hardships, in distresses, 006:005 in beatings, in imprisonments, in riots, in labors, in watchings, in fastings; 006:006 in pureness, in knowledge, in patience, in kindness, in the Holy Spirit, in sincere love, 006:007 in the word of truth, in the power of God; by the armor of righteousness on the right hand

and on the left, 006:008 by glory and dishonor, by evil report and good report; as deceivers, and yet true; 006:009 as unknown, and yet well known; as dying, and behold, we live; as punished, and not killed; 006:010 as sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; as poor, yet making many rich; as having nothing, and yet possessing all things. 006:011 Our mouth is open to you, Corinthians. Our heart is enlarged. 006:012 You are not restricted by us, but you are restricted by your own affections. 006:013 Now in return, I speak as to my children, you also be open wide. 006:014 Don't be unequally yoked with

unbelievers, for what fellowship have righteousness and iniquity? Or what communion has light with darkness? 006:015 What agreement has Christ with Belial? Or what portion has a believer with an unbeliever? 006:016 What agreement has a temple of God with idols? For you are a temple of the living God. Even as God said, "I will dwell in them, and walk in them; and I will be their God, and they will be my people." {Leviticus 26:12; Jeremiah 32:38; Ezekiel 37:27} 006:017 Therefore, "'Come out from among them, and be separate,' says the Lord. 'Touch no unclean thing. I will receive you.

**{Isaiah 52:11; Ezekiel 20:34,41}
006:018 I will be to you a Father.
You will be to me sons and
daughters,' says the Lord
Almighty." {2 Samuel 7:14; 7:8}
007:001 Having therefore these
promises, beloved, let us cleanse
ourselves from all defilement of
flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness
in the fear of God. 007:002 Open
your hearts to us. We wronged no
one. We corrupted no one. We took
advantage of no one. 007:003 I say
this not to condemn you, for I have
said before, that you are in our
hearts to die together and live
together. 007:004 Great is my
boldness of speech toward you.**

Great is my boasting on your behalf. I am filled with comfort. I overflow with joy in all our affliction. 007:005 For even when we had come into Macedonia, our flesh had no relief, but we were afflicted on every side. Fightings were outside. Fear was inside. 007:006 Nevertheless, he who comforts the lowly, God, comforted us by the coming of Titus; 007:007 and not by his coming only, but also by the comfort with which he was comforted in you, while he told us of your longing, your mourning, and your zeal for me; so that I rejoiced still more. 007:008 For though I made you sorry with my

letter, I do not regret it, though I did regret it. For I see that my letter made you sorry, though just for a while. 007:009 I now rejoice, not that you were made sorry, but that you were made sorry to repentance. For you were made sorry in a godly way, that you might suffer loss by us in nothing. 007:010 For godly sorrow works repentance to salvation, which brings no regret. But the sorrow of the world works death. 007:011 For behold, this same thing, that you were made sorry in a godly way, what earnest care it worked in you. Yes, what defense, indignation, fear, longing, zeal, and vengeance! In

**everything you demonstrated
yourselves to be pure in the matter.**

**007:012 So although I wrote to you,
I wrote not for his cause that did
the wrong, nor for his cause that
suffered the wrong, but that your
earnest care for us might be
revealed in you in the sight of God.**

**007:013 Therefore we have been
comforted. In our comfort we
rejoiced the more exceedingly for
the joy of Titus, because his spirit
has been refreshed by you all.**

**007:014 For if in anything I have
boasted to him on your behalf, I
was not disappointed. But as we
spoke all things to you in truth, so
our glorying also which I made**

**before Titus was found to be truth.
007:015 His affection is more
abundantly toward you, while he
remembers all of your obedience,
how with fear and trembling you
received him. 007:016 I rejoice that
in everything I am of good courage
concerning you. 008:001 Moreover,
brothers, we make known to you
the grace of God which has been
given in the assemblies of
Macedonia; 008:002 how that in
much proof of affliction the
abundance of their joy and their
deep poverty abounded to the
riches of their liberality. 008:003
For according to their power, I
testify, yes and beyond their power,**

**they gave of their own accord,
008:004 begging us with much
entreaty to receive this grace and
the fellowship in the service to the
saints. 008:005 This was not as we
had hoped, but first they gave their
own selves to the Lord, and to us
through the will of God. 008:006 So
we urged Titus, that as he made a
beginning before, so he would also
complete in you this grace. 008:007
But as you abound in everything, in
faith, utterance, knowledge, all
earnestness, and in your love to us,
see that you also abound in this
grace. 008:008 I speak not by way
of commandment, but as proving
through the earnestness of others**

the sincerity also of your love.

008:009 For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that you through his poverty might become rich.

008:010 I give a judgment in this: for this is expedient for you, who were the first to start a year ago, not only to do, but also to be willing. 008:011 But now complete the doing also, that as there was the readiness to be willing, so there may be the completion also out of your ability. 008:012 For if the readiness is there, it is acceptable according to what you have, not according to what you don't have.

008:013 For this is not that others may be eased and you distressed, 008:014 but for equality. Your abundance at this present time supplies their lack, that their abundance also may become a supply for your lack; that there may be equality. 008:015 As it is written, "He who gathered much had nothing left over, and he who gathered little had no lack." {Exodus 16:8} 008:016 But thanks be to God, who puts the same earnest care for you into the heart of Titus. 008:017 For he indeed accepted our exhortation, but being himself very earnest, he went out to you of his own accord. 008:018 We

have sent together with him the brother whose praise in the Good News is known through all the assemblies. 008:019 Not only so, but who was also appointed by the assemblies to travel with us in this grace, which is served by us to the glory of the Lord himself, and to show our readiness. 008:020 We are avoiding this, that any man should blame us concerning this abundance which is administered by us. 008:021 Having regard for honorable things, not only in the sight of the Lord, but also in the sight of men. 008:022 We have sent with them our brother, whom we have many times proved earnest in

many things, but now much more earnest, by reason of the great confidence which he has in you.

008:023 As for Titus, he is my partner and fellow worker for you.

As for our brothers, they are the apostles of the assemblies, the glory

of Christ. 008:024 Therefore show the proof of your love to them in

front of the assemblies, and of our boasting on your behalf. 009:001 It

is indeed unnecessary for me to

write to you concerning the service to the saints, 009:002 for I know

your readiness, of which I boast on your behalf to them of Macedonia,

that Achaia has been prepared for a year past. Your zeal has stirred

**up very many of them. 009:003 But
I have sent the brothers that our
boasting on your behalf may not be
in vain in this respect, that, just as I
said, you may be prepared, 009:004
so that I won't by any means, if
there come with me any of
Macedonia and find you
unprepared, we (to say nothing of
you) should be disappointed in this
confident boasting. 009:005 I
thought it necessary therefore to
entreat the brothers that they
would go before to you, and
arrange ahead of time the generous
gift that you promised before, that
the same might be ready as a
matter of generosity, and not of**

greediness. 009:006 Remember this: he who sows sparingly will also reap sparingly. He who sows bountifully will also reap bountifully. 009:007 Let each man give according as he has determined in his heart; not grudgingly, or under compulsion; for God loves a cheerful giver. 009:008 And God is able to make all grace abound to you, that you, always having all sufficiency in everything, may abound to every good work. 009:009 As it is written, "He has scattered abroad, he has given to the poor. His righteousness remains forever." {Psalm 112:9} 009:010 Now may he who supplies

seed to the sower and bread for food, supply and multiply your seed for sowing, and increase the fruits of your righteousness; 009:011 you being enriched in everything to all liberality, which works through us thanksgiving to God. 009:012 For this service of giving that you perform not only makes up for lack among the saints, but abounds also through many givings of thanks to God; 009:013 seeing that through the proof given by this service, they glorify God for the obedience of your confession to the Good News of Christ, and for the liberality of your contribution to them and to all; 009:014 while they themselves

also, with supplication on your behalf, yearn for you by reason of the exceeding grace of God in you. 009:015 Now thanks be to God for his unspeakable gift! 010:001 Now I Paul, myself, entreat you by the humility and gentleness of Christ; I who in your presence am lowly among you, but being absent am of good courage toward you. 010:002 Yes, I beg you that I may not, when present, show courage with the confidence with which I intend to be bold against some, who consider us to be walking according to the flesh. 010:003 For though we walk in the flesh, we don't wage war according to the flesh; 010:004 for

the weapons of our warfare are not of the flesh, but mighty before God to the throwing down of strongholds, 010:005 throwing down imaginations and every high thing that is exalted against the knowledge of God, and bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ; 010:006 and being in readiness to avenge all disobedience, when your obedience will be made full. 010:007 Do you look at things only as they appear in front of your face? If anyone trusts in himself that he is Christ's, let him consider this again with himself, that, even as he is Christ's, so also we are Christ's. 010:008 For

though I should boast somewhat abundantly concerning our authority, (which the Lord gave for building you up, and not for casting you down) I will not be disappointed, 010:009 that I may not seem as if I desire to terrify you by my letters. 010:010 For, "His letters," they say, "are weighty and strong, but his bodily presence is weak, and his speech is despised." 010:011 Let such a person consider this, that what we are in word by letters when we are absent, such are we also in deed when we are present. 010:012 For we are not bold to number or compare ourselves with some of those who

commend themselves. But they themselves, measuring themselves by themselves, and comparing themselves with themselves, are without understanding. 010:013

But we will not boast beyond proper limits, but within the boundaries with which God appointed to us, which reach even to you. 010:014 For we don't stretch ourselves too much, as though we didn't reach to you. For we came even as far as to you with the Good News of Christ, 010:015 not boasting beyond proper limits in other men's labors, but having hope that as your faith grows, we will be abundantly enlarged by you

**in our sphere of influence, 010:016
so as to preach the Good News even
to the parts beyond you, not to
boast in what someone else has
already done. 010:017 But "he who
boasts, let him boast in the Lord."
{Jeremiah 9:24} 010:018 For it isn't
he who commends himself who is
approved, but whom the Lord
commends. 011:001 I wish that you
would bear with me in a little
foolishness, but indeed you do bear
with me. 011:002 For I am jealous
over you with a godly jealousy. For
I married you to one husband, that
I might present you as a pure
virgin to Christ. 011:003 But I am
afraid that somehow, as the serpent**

**deceived Eve in his craftiness, so
your minds might be corrupted
from the simplicity that is in
Christ. 011:004 For if he who
comes preaches another Jesus,
whom we did not preach, or if you
receive a different spirit, which you
did not receive, or a different "good
news", which you did not accept,
you put up with that well enough.
011:005 For I reckon that I am not
at all behind the very best apostles.
011:006 But though I am unskilled
in speech, yet I am not unskilled in
knowledge. No, in every way we
have been revealed to you in all
things. 011:007 Or did I commit a
sin in humbling myself that you**

**might be exalted, because I
preached to you God's Good News
free of charge? 011:008 I robbed
other assemblies, taking wages
from them that I might serve you.
011:009 When I was present with
you and was in need, I wasn't a
burden on anyone, for the brothers,
when they came from Macedonia,
supplied the measure of my need.
In everything I kept myself from
being burdensome to you, and I
will continue to do so. 011:010 As
the truth of Christ is in me, no one
will stop me from this boasting in
the regions of Achaia. 011:011
Why? Because I don't love you?
God knows. 011:012 But what I do,**

that I will do, that I may cut off occasion from them that desire an occasion, that in which they boast, they may be found even as we.

011:013 For such men are false apostles, deceitful workers, masquerading as Christ's apostles.

011:014 And no wonder, for even Satan masquerades as an angel of light. 011:015 It is no great thing

therefore if his servants also masquerade as servants of

righteousness, whose end will be according to their works. 011:016 I

say again, let no one think me foolish. But if so, yet receive me as foolish, that I also may boast a

little. 011:017 That which I speak, I

**don't speak according to the Lord,
but as in foolishness, in this
confidence of boasting. 011:018
Seeing that many boast after the
flesh, I will also boast. 011:019 For
you bear with the foolish gladly,
being wise. 011:020 For you bear
with a man, if he brings you into
bondage, if he devours you, if he
takes you captive, if he exalts
himself, if he strikes you on the
face. 011:021 I speak by way of
disparagement, as though we had
been weak. Yet however any is bold
(I speak in foolishness), I am bold
also. 011:022 Are they Hebrews? So
am I. Are they Israelites? So am I.
Are they the seed of Abraham? So**

**am I. 011:023 Are they servants of
Christ? (I speak as one beside
himself) I am more so; in labors
more abundantly, in prisons more
abundantly, in stripes above
measure, in deaths often. 011:024
Five times from the Jews I received
forty stripes minus one. 011:025
Three times I was beaten with rods.
Once I was stoned. Three times I
suffered shipwreck. I have been a
night and a day in the deep.
011:026 I have been in travels
often, perils of rivers, perils of
robbers, perils from my
countrymen, perils from the
Gentiles, perils in the city, perils in
the wilderness, perils in the sea,**

**perils among false brothers;
011:027 in labor and travail, in
watchings often, in hunger and
thirst, in fastings often, and in cold
and nakedness. 011:028 Besides
those things that are outside, there
is that which presses on me daily,
anxiety for all the assemblies.
011:029 Who is weak, and I am not
weak? Who is caused to stumble,
and I don't burn with indignation?
011:030 If I must boast, I will boast
of the things that concern my
weakness. 011:031 The God and
Father of the Lord Jesus Christ, he
who is blessed forevermore, knows
that I don't lie. 011:032 In
Damascus the governor under**

Aretas the king guarded the city of the Damascenes desiring to arrest me. 011:033 Through a window I was let down in a basket by the wall, and escaped his hands.

012:001 It is doubtless not profitable for me to boast. For I will come to visions and revelations of the Lord. 012:002 I know a man in Christ, fourteen years ago (whether in the body, I don't know, or whether out of the body, I don't know; God knows), such a one caught up into the third heaven.

012:003 I know such a man (whether in the body, or outside of the body, I don't know; God knows), 012:004 how he was caught

**up into Paradise, and heard
unspeakable words, which it is not
lawful for a man to utter. 012:005
On behalf of such a one I will boast,
but on my own behalf I will not
boast, except in my weaknesses.
012:006 For if I would desire to
boast, I will not be foolish; for I will
speak the truth. But I refrain, so
that no man may think more of me
than that which he sees in me, or
hears from me. 012:007 By reason
of the exceeding greatness of the
revelations, that I should not be
exalted excessively, there was given
to me a thorn in the flesh, a
messenger of Satan to torment me,
that I should not be exalted**

excessively. 012:008 Concerning this thing, I begged the Lord three times that it might depart from me. 012:009 He has said to me, "My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness." Most gladly therefore I will rather glory in my weaknesses, that the power of Christ may rest on me. 012:010 Therefore I take pleasure in weaknesses, in injuries, in necessities, in persecutions, in distresses, for Christ's sake. For when I am weak, then am I strong. 012:011 I have become foolish in boasting. You compelled me, for I ought to have been commended by you, for in nothing was I inferior to

the very best apostles, though I am nothing. 012:012 Truly the signs of an apostle were worked among you in all patience, in signs and wonders and mighty works.

012:013 For what is there in which you were made inferior to the rest of the assemblies, unless it is that I myself was not a burden to you?

Forgive me this wrong. 012:014

Behold, this is the third time I am ready to come to you, and I will not be a burden to you; for I seek not your possessions, but you. For the children ought not to save up for the parents, but the parents for the children. 012:015 I will most gladly spend and be spent for your souls.

If I love you more abundantly, am I loved the less? 012:016 But be it so, I did not myself burden you. But, being crafty, I caught you with deception. 012:017 Did I take advantage of you by anyone of them whom I have sent to you? 012:018 I exhorted Titus, and I sent the brother with him. Did Titus take any advantage of you? Didn't we walk in the same spirit? Didn't we walk in the same steps? 012:019 Again, do you think that we are excusing ourselves to you? In the sight of God we speak in Christ. But all things, beloved, are for your edifying. 012:020 For I am afraid that by any means, when I come, I

might find you not the way I want to, and that I might be found by you as you don't desire; that by any means there would be strife, jealousy, outbursts of anger, factions, slander, whisperings, proud thoughts, riots; 012:021 that again when I come my God would humble me before you, and I would mourn for many of those who have sinned before now, and not repented of the uncleanness and sexual immorality and lustfulness which they committed. 013:001 This is the third time I am coming to you. "At the mouth of two or three witnesses shall every word established." {Deuteronomy 19:15}

**013:002 I have said beforehand,
and I do say beforehand, as when I
was present the second time, so
now, being absent, I write to those
who have sinned before now, and to
all the rest, that, if I come again, I
will not spare; 013:003 seeing that
you seek a proof of Christ who
speaks in me; who toward you is
not weak, but is powerful in you.
013:004 For he was crucified
through weakness, yet he lives
through the power of God. For we
also are weak in him, but we will
live with him through the power of
God toward you. 013:005 Test your
own selves, whether you are in the
faith. Test your own selves. Or**

**don't you know as to your own
selves, that Jesus Christ is in you?
—unless indeed you are
disqualified. 013:006 But I hope
that you will know that we aren't
disqualified. 013:007 Now I pray to
God that you do no evil; not that
we may appear approved, but that
you may do that which is
honorable, though we are as
reprobate. 013:008 For we can do
nothing against the truth, but for
the truth. 013:009 For we rejoice
when we are weak and you are
strong. And this we also pray for,
even your perfecting. 013:010 For
this cause I write these things while
absent, that I may not deal sharply**

when present, according to the authority which the Lord gave me for building up, and not for tearing down. 013:011 Finally, brothers, rejoice. Be perfected, be comforted, be of the same mind, live in peace, and the God of love and peace will be with you. 013:012 Greet one another with a holy kiss. 013:013 All the saints greet you. 013:014 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Spirit, be with you all. Amen.

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